**Test 15:**

## READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 1–13, which are based on Reading Passage 1 on pages 2 and 3.*

### Ahead of its time

*A chance discovery in New Zealand has challenged the country's recorded history*

One October afternoon, a young New Zealander, Sam Tobin, called his dogs and went for a walk down to the nearby Ruamahanga River. Having been very high for days, the river had at last fallen, and Tobin was eager to see what changes the floods had brought. The family farm borders the river and a four-metre-high flood bank testifies to its natural tendency to flood.

Tobin stepped out onto a broad shoulder of river sand, where he noticed what he initially took to be a whitish rock, lit by the sun. Then, getting closer, he realised it was a bone. Such a thing was not uncommon in these parts - he had often come across bone fragments, or even whole skeletons, of cows and sheep. But as he scraped aside the stones he realised it was a human bone, something quite new in his experience. As he picked it up, he saw it was a skull, discoloured with age.

Tobin replaced the skull and hurried home to tell his mother what the river had delivered to their doorstep. It would prove to be a spectacular find, setting in motion an investigation by some of the country's most respected specialists, and ultimately challenging our most firmly held assertions about the human settlement of New Zealand.

The police were immediately called, but despite a thorough search could find nothing that might shed light on the identity of the Ruamahanga skull, or the circumstances of its sudden appearance. The skull was then taken north to be examined by forensic pathologist Dr Ferris, at Auckland Hospital. Despite being hampered by its damaged and incomplete condition - the jawbone and lower left portion of the cranium were

missing - Dr Ferris determined that the skull was that of a female. He then consulted with a colleague, Dr Koelmeyer, who believed that the deterioration of the bone placed the time of death 'before living memory' and, most significantly as it would turn out, the skull appeared to be European in origin.

Wellington-based forensic anthropologist Dr Watt also examined the skull, and suggested it belonged to a 40-45 year-old. He believed that it could be the remains of an old farm burial, but was not certain, and proposed the use of radiocarbon dating to make sure it wasn't a recent death. As a result, the Institute of Geological and Nuclear Sciences (GNS) in Lower Hutt was contacted, and provided with a sample of bone that had originated in the top of the skull. In a little over three weeks the seemingly astonishing results from the GNS laboratory came back. Cutting through the bewildering complexity of the scientific analysis was a single line reading: conventional radiocarbon age approximately 296 years. This was staggering, for the skull was about 200 years older than Dr Koelmeyer had believed.

Of course, a skull of this age wasn't particularly unusual in New Zealand. The Maori people have been living in the country for at least 800 years and scientists frequently come across human remains of considerable age. The fascinating question, however, was how a skull of this race, let alone this gender, had reached these remote islands in the South Pacific at such a time, long before the arrival of the explorer Captain Cook in 1769, and perhaps even before the very first European landfall - the fleeting visit of the Dutch explorer Tasman in 1642 - neither of whom had women among their crews.

The first known European women in the Pacific came with a doomed colonising venture which sailed from Peru in 1595 under the command of Spanish captain Mendana. However, it is unlikely the Ruamahanga skull originated from this expedition because no evidence of Mendana's ships has ever been found in New Zealand, while a team of archaeologists working in the Solomon Islands in 1970 did discover the remains of European vessels dating from the 16th century.

Two centuries were to pass before the first recorded European females arrived in New Zealand, both having escaped from prison in Australia. Kathleen Hagerty and

Charlotte Edgar are known to have reached the country in 1806. How then do we account for the Ruamahanga skull, which appears to be about 100 years older than that? It is impossible to say with certainty, but the most likely explanation is that a Spanish or Portuguese trading-hip was washed onto these wild shores as a result of a shipwreck and a woman got ashore. Implausible, perhaps, but the Ruamahanga skull, today resting in the Wellington Museum, could be the kind of concrete evidence that demands such a drastic re-evaluation of history.

TRUE IELTS

**Questions 1–4**

*Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?*

*In boxes 1–4 on your answer sheet, write*

**TRUE** *if the statement agrees with the information*
**FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information*
**NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

**1** The Ruamahanga River often floods.

**2** When Tobin first found the object in the river, he mistook it for something else.

**3** Tobin could not decide what part of the body the bone came from.

**4** Tobin's mother was surprised that the skull caused debate among specialists.

IELTS

**Questions 5–9**

*Complete the flow-chart below.*

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes 5–9 on your answer sheet.*

## The events after the river flooded

Tobin found a human skull.

↓

The **5 .....** were initially involved in trying to explain the presence of the skull.

↓

Dr Fetvis believed the skull belonged to a female.

↓

Dr Koelmeyer suggested it was a **6 .....** skull.

↓

Dr Watt recommended **7 .....** to establish the skull's age.

↓

A bone **8 .....** was sent to the GNS.

↓

The age of the skull was about **9 .....** years.

**Questions 10–13**

*Complete the notes below.*

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes 10–13 on your answer sheet.*

**Problem of the skull's origins**

- old bones common in New Zealand
- Maori living there for 800 years
- Ruamahanga skull surprising because of its:
    - age
    - **10 .....**
    - gender

**Mendana expedition**

- possible source of skull
- but probably did not visit New Zealand
- evidence of this expedition found elsewhere by **11 .....**

**New Zealand**

- first European explorer arrived in 1642
- Hagerty and Edgar arrived in 1806 from **12 .....**, where they had been imprisoned

**Possible solution**

- Ruamahanga skull may have reached New Zealand in 17th century after a **13 .....**

## ĐÁP ÁN:

**1. TRUE** (Đoạn 1 nhắc đến việc con sông có xu hướng tự nhiên là gây lũ lụt và có một bờ ngăn lũ cao 4 mét

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

The family farm borders the river and a four-metre-high flood bank testifies to its natural tendency to flood.

**2. TRUE** (Ban đầu Tobin tưởng lầm đó là một hòn đá màu trắng dưới ánh mặt trời

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

Tobin stepped out onto a broad shoulder of river sand, where he noticed what he initially took to be a whitish rock, lit by the sun.

**3. FALSE** (Ngay khi gạt hòn đá sang một bên, anh nhận ra đó là xương người và khi nhặt lên thì thấy đó là một hộp sọ

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

As he picked it up, he saw it was a skull, discoloured with age.

**4. NOT GIVEN** (Bài đọc có nói Tobin về kể với mẹ, nhưng không đề cập đến phản ứng ngạc nhiên hay cảm xúc của bà về cuộc tranh luận giữa các chuyên gia

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

Tobin replaced the skull and hurried home to tell his mother what the river had delivered to their doorstep. It would prove to be a spectacular find, setting in motion an investigation by some of the country's most respected specialists

**5. police** (Cảnh sát được gọi đến ngay lập tức để xác định danh tính hộp sọ

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

The police were immediately called, but despite a thorough search could find nothing that might shed light on the identity of the Ruamahanga skull, or the circumstances of its sudden appearance.

**6. European** (Bác sĩ Koelmeyer tin rằng hộp sọ này có nguồn gốc từ Châu Âu

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

He then consulted with a colleague, Dr Koelmeyer, who believed that the deterioration of the bone placed the time of death 'before living memory' and, most significantly as it would turn out, the skull appeared to be European in origin.

**7. radiocarbon dating** (Bác sĩ Watt đề xuất sử dụng phương pháp định tuổi bằng carbon để xác định tuổi của hộp sọ

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

Wellington-based forensic anthropologist Dr Watt also examined the skull, and suggested it belonged to a 40-45 year-old. He believed that it could be the remains of an old farm burial, but was not certain, and proposed the use of radiocarbon dating to make sure it wasn't a recent death.

**8. sample** (Một mẫu xương từ đỉnh hộp sọ đã được gửi đến phòng thí nghiệm GNS

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

As a result, the Institute of Geological and Nuclear Sciences (GNS) in Lower Hutt was contacted, and provided with a sample of bone that had originated in the top of the skull

**9. 296** (Kết quả định tuổi cho thấy hộp sọ có tuổi đời khoảng 296 năm

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

Cutting through the bewildering complexity of the scientific analysis was a single line reading: conventional radiocarbon age approximately 296 years.

**10. race** (Hộp sọ Ruamahanga gây ngạc nhiên vì tuổi tác, chủng tộc và giới tính của nó

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

The fascinating question, however, was how a skull of this race, let alone this gender, had reached these remote islands in the South Pacific at such a time

**11. archaeologists** (Bằng chứng về đoàn thám hiểm của Mendana được tìm thấy bởi các nhà khảo cổ tại quần đảo Solomon

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

However, it is unlikely the Ruamahanga skull originated from this expedition because no evidence of Mendana's ships has ever been found in New Zealand, while a team of archaeologists working in the Solomon Islands in 1970 did discover the remains of European vessels dating from the 16th century.

**12. Australia** (Hagerty và Edgar đến New Zealand vào năm 1806 sau khi trốn thoát khỏi nhà tù ở Úc

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

Two centuries were to pass before the first recorded European females arrived in New Zealand, both having escaped from prison in Australia. Kathleen Hagerty and Charlotte Edgar are known to have reached the country in 1806.

**13. shipwreck** (Giải thích khả dĩ nhất là một con tàu buôn bị đắm đã đưa người phụ nữ này lên bờ vào thế kỷ 17 (P1 - Ahead... p. 2)).

***Đoạn chứa đáp án***:

How then do we account for the Ruamahanga skull, which appears to be about 100 years older than that? It is impossible to say with certainty, but the most likely explanation is that a Spanish or Portuguese trading-hip was washed onto these wild shores as a result of a shipwreck and a woman got ashore.

## READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

# Keeping the water away

*New approaches to flood control*

**A** Recently, winter floods on the rivers of central Europe have been among the worst for 600 to 700 years, and dams and dykes (protective sea walls) have failed to solve the problem. Traditionally, river engineers have tried to get rid of the water quickly, draining it off the land and down to the sea in rivers reengineered as high-performance drains. But however high they build the artificial riverbanks, the floods keep coming back. And when they come, they seem to be worse than ever.

**B** Engineers are now turning to a different plan: to sap the water's destructive strength by dispersing it into fields, forgotten lakes and flood plains. They are reviving river bends and marshes to curb the flow, and even plugging city drains to encourage floodwater to use other means to go underground. Back in the days when rivers took a winding path to the sea, floodwaters lost force and volume while meandering across flood plains and inland deltas, but today the water tends to have a direct passage to the sea. This means that, when it rains in the uplands, the water comes down all at once.

**C** Worse, when the flood plains are closed off, the river's flow downstream becomes more violent and uncontrollable; by turning complex river systems into the simple mechanics of a water pipe, engineers have often created danger where they promised safety. The Rhine, Europe's most engineered river, is a good example. For a long time engineers have erased its backwaters and cut it off from its plain. The aim was partly to improve navigation, and partly to speed floodwaters out of the Alps and down to the North Sea. Now, when it rains in the Alps, the peak flows from several branches of the Rhine coincide where once they arrived separately, and with four-fifths of the Lower Rhine's flood plain barricaded off, the waters rise. The result is more frequent flooding and greater damage. The same thing has happened in the US on the Mississippi River, which drains the world's second-largest river catchment into the Gulf of Mexico. Despite some $7 billion spent over the last century on levees (embankments), the situation is growing worse.

**D** Specialists in water control now say that a new approach is needed — one which takes the whole landscape into consideration. To help keep London's feet dry, the UK Environment

Agency is reflooding 10 square kilometres of the ancient flood plain of the River Thames outside Oxford. Nearer to London, it has spent £100 million creating new wetlands and a relief channel across 16 kilometres of flood plain. Similar ideas are being tested in Austria, in one of Europe's largest river restorations to date. The engineers calculate that the restored flood plain of the Drava River can now store up to 10 million cubic metres of floodwater, and slow down storm surges coming out of the Alps by more than an hour, protecting towns not only in Austria, but as far downstream as Slovenia and Croatia.

**E** The Dutch, for whom preventing floods is a matter of survival, have gone furthest. This nation, built largely on drained marshes and seabed, has had several severe shocks in the last two decades, when very large numbers of people have had to be evacuated. Since that time, the Dutch have broken one of their most enduring national stereotypes by allowing engineers to punch holes in dykes. They plan to return up to a sixth of the country to its former waterlogged state in order to better protect the rest.

**F** Water use in cities also needs to change. At the moment, cities seem to create floods: they are concreted and paved so that rains flow quickly into rivers. A new breed of 'soft engineers' wants cities to be porous; Berlin is one place where this is being done. Tough new rules for new developments mean that drains will be prevented from becoming overloaded after heavy rains. Architects of new urban buildings are diverting rainwater from the roofs for use in toilets and the irrigation of roof gardens, while water falling onto the ground is collected in ponds, or passes underground through porous paving. One high-tech urban development can store a sixth of its annual rainfall, and reuse most of the rest.

**G** Could this be expanded to protect a whole city? The test case could be Los Angeles. With non-porous surfaces covering 70% of the city, drainage is a huge challenge. Billions of dollars have been spent digging huge drains and concreting riverbeds, but many communities still flood regularly. Meanwhile, this desert city ships water from hundreds of kilometres away to fill its taps and swimming pool. Los Angeles has recently launched a new scheme to utilise floodwater in the Sun Valley section of the city. The plan is to catch the rain that falls on thousands of driveways, parking lots and rooftops in the valley. Trees will soak up water from parking lots; houses and public buildings will capture roof water to irrigate gardens and parks, and road drains will empty into old gravel pits to recharge the city's underground water reserves. Result: less flooding and more water for the city. It may sound expensive, until we realise how much is spent trying to drain cities and protect areas from flooding, and how little this method achieves.

## Questions 14–19

*Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs,* ***A–G****.*

*Which paragraph contains the following information?*

*Write the correct letter,* ***A–G****, in boxes 1–6 on your answer sheet.*

**14** how legislation has forced building designers to improve water use

**15** two reasons why one river was isolated from its flood plain

**16** how natural watercourses in the past assisted flood control

**17** an example of flood control on one river, affecting three countries

**18** a country which has partly destroyed one of its most typical features in order to control water

**19** the writer's comment on the comparative cost-effectiveness of traditional flood control and newer methods

## Questions 20 and 21

*Choose* ***TWO*** *letters* ***A–E****.*

*Write the correct letters in boxes 20 and 21 on your answer sheet.*

According to the article, which **TWO** of these statements are true of the new approach to flood control?

**A** It aims to slow the movement of water to the sea.
**B** It aims to channel water more directly into rivers.
**C** It will cost more than twice as much as former measures.
**D** It will involve the loss of some areas of land.
**E** It has been tested only in the Netherlands.

## Questions 22–26

*Complete the sentences below.*

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.*

*Write your answers in boxes 22–26 on your answer sheet.*

**22** Some of the most severe floods for many centuries have recently occurred in parts of _____.

**23** The Rhine and the _____ river have experienced similar problems with water control.

**24** An area near Oxford will be flooded to protect the city of _____.

**25** Planners who wish to allow water to pass more freely through city surfaces are called _____.

**26** A proposal for part of the city of _____ could show whether small-scale water projects could be applied on a large scale.

**ĐÁP ÁN:**

**14. F**: Đề cập đến các quy tắc mới (tough new rules) buộc các kiến trúc sư phải chuyển hướng nước mưa để sử dụng cho bồn cầu và tưới vườn.

This paragraph describes how in Berlin, "Tough new rules for new developments mean that drains will be prevented from becoming overloaded..." and that architects are "diverting rainwater from the roofs for use in toilets...". This is legislation forcing building designers to improve water use.

**15. C**: Nêu hai lý do sông Rhine bị tách khỏi đồng lũ: cải thiện giao thông thủy (navigation) và đẩy nhanh nước lũ ra biển Bắc.

This paragraph explains that the Rhine was engineered for two main reasons: "partly to improve navigation, and partly to speed floodwaters out of Alps and down to the North Sea."

**16. B**: Mô tả trong quá khứ, các dòng sông uốn lượn (winding path) đã giúp nước lũ giảm lực và thể tích khi chảy qua các vùng đồng bằng.

This paragraph describes the past, "when rivers took a winding path to the sea, floodwaters lost force and volume while meandering across flood plains and inland deltas," which assisted flood control.

**17. D**: Ví dụ về sông Drava giúp bảo vệ các thị trấn ở Áo, Slovenia và Croatia.

This paragraph gives the example of the "restored flood plain of the Drava River," which helps protect towns in three countries: "Austria... as far downstream as Slovenia and Croatia."

**18. E**: Đề cập đến Hà Lan (The Dutch) đã phá bỏ hình ảnh quen thuộc bằng cách đục lỗ trên các con đê (dykes).

This paragraph describes how the Dutch, a nation famous for its dykes (a typical feature), have now begun to "punch holes in dykes" and return land to a waterlogged state to better protect the rest of the country.

**19. G**: Tác giả nhận xét rằng phương pháp mới nghe có vẻ tốn kém nhưng thực tế phương pháp cũ tốn rất nhiều tiền mà hiệu quả lại thấp.

The final paragraph discusses the new scheme in Los Angeles and concludes by comparing its potential cost to how much is currently spent on traditional methods: "...until we realise how much is spent trying to drain cities... and how little this method achieves." This is a comment on comparative cost effectiveness.

**Questions 20 and 21:**

**A (It aims to slow the movement of water to the sea)**: Mục tiêu là làm chậm dòng chảy bằng cách phân tán nước vào cánh đồng, hồ và vùng đất ngập nước.

The new approach described in Paragraph B involves "dispersing it into fields," "reviving river bends and marshes to curb the flow." This aims to slow the movement of water to the sea.

**D (It will involve the loss of some areas of land)**: Hà Lan có kế hoạch trả lại tới 1/6 diện tích đất nước cho trạng thái ngập nước trước đây.

Paragraph E explains that the Dutch plan to "return up to a sixth of the country to its former waterlogged state," which will involve the loss of some areas of land currently used for other purposes.

**Questions 22–26:**

**22. central Europe**: Những trận lũ tồi tệ nhất trong nhiều thế kỷ đã xảy ra ở các vùng thuộc **Trung Âu**.

Paragraph A begins, "...winter floods on the rivers of central Europe have been among the worst for 600 to 700 years...".

**23. Mississippi**: Sông Rhine và sông **Mississippi** đều gặp vấn đề tương tự về kiểm soát nước.

Paragraph C, after discussing the Rhine, states, "The same thing has happened in the US on the Mississippi river...".

**24. London**: Một khu vực gần Oxford sẽ được làm ngập để bảo vệ thành phố **London**.

Paragraph D explains that the UK Environment Agency is taking measures on the Thames "To help keep London's feet dry...".

**25. soft engineers**: Những nhà quy hoạch muốn nước đi qua bề mặt thành phố tự do hơn được gọi là những "**kỹ sư mềm**".

Paragraph F introduces this term for planners who want cities to be porous: "A new breed of 'soft engineers' wants cities to porous...".

**26. Los Angeles**: Đề xuất cho một phần của thành phố **Los Angeles** có thể cho thấy liệu các dự án nhỏ có thể áp dụng trên quy mô lớn hay không.

Paragraph G presents a new scheme in "Los Angeles" as "The test case" for protecting a whole city.

## READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

# Australia's Megafauna Controversy

*Just how long did humans live side by side with megafauna in Australia? Barry Brook, Richard Gillespie and Paul Martin dispute previous claims of a lengthy coexistence.*

Over the past 50 millennia, Australia has witnessed the extinction of many species of large animals, including a rhinoceros-sized wombat and goannas the size of crocodiles. Debate about the possible cause of these extinctions has continued for more than 150 years, and one of the crucial questions raised is how long humans and megafauna coexisted in Australia. We need to know the overlap of time to make an informed choice between the two main theories regarding the causes of these extinctions. If humans and megafauna coexisted for a protracted period, then climate change is the more likely cause. However, if the megafauna became extinct shortly after the arrival of humans, then humans are the likely culprits.

The archaeological site at Cuddie Springs in eastern Australia appears to be well preserved. This dusty claypan holds within its sediments a rich cache of flaked stone and seed-grinding tools, and side by side with these clear signals of human culture are the bones of a dozen or more species of megafauna. Drs Judith Field and Stephen Wroe of the University of Sydney, who excavated the site, claim that it provides unequivocal evidence of a long overlap of humans and megafauna, and conclude that aridity leading up to the last Ice Age brought about their eventual demise. In the long-standing explanation of this site, artefacts such as stone tools and extinct animal remains were deposited over many thousands of years in an ephemeral lake – a body of water existing for a relatively short time – and remained in place and undisturbed until the present day.

There is no disputing the close association of bones and stones at Cuddie Springs, as both are found 1 to 1.7 metres below the modern surface. The dating of these layers is accurate: ages for the sediments were obtained through radiocarbon dating of charcoal fragments and luminescence dating of sand grains from the same levels (revealing when a sample was last exposed to sunlight). Intriguingly, some of the stone tools show surface features indicating their use for processing plants, and a few even have well-preserved blood and hair residues suggesting they were used in butchering animals.

But is the case proposed by Field and Wroe clear-cut? We carried out a reanalysis of the scientific data from Cuddie Springs that brings into question their conclusions. The amount of anthropological evidence found at the site is remarkable: we estimate there are more than 3 tonnes of charcoal and more than 300 tonnes of stone buried there. Field and Wroe estimate that there are approximately 20 million artefacts. This plethora of tools is hard to reconcile with a site that was only available for occupation when the lake was dry. Furthermore, no cultural features, such as oven pits, have been discovered. If the sediment

layers have remained undisturbed since being laid down, as Field and Wroe contend, then the ages of those sediments should increase with depth. However, our analysis revealed a number of inconsistencies.

First, the charcoal samples are all roughly 36,000 years old. Second, sand in the two upper levels is considerably younger than charcoal from the same levels. Third, Field and Wroe say that the tools and seed-grinding stones used for plant and animal processing are ancient, yet they are very similar to implements found elsewhere that were in use only a few thousand years ago. Also of interest is the fact that a deep drill core made a mere 60 metres from the site recovered no stone artefacts or fossil bones whatsoever. These points suggest strongly that the sediments have been moved about and some of the old charcoal has been re-deposited in younger layers. Indeed, one sample of cow bone found 1 metre below the surface came from sediments where charcoal dated at 6,000 and 23,000 years old is mixed with 17,000-year-old sand. The megafauna bones themselves have not yet been dated, although new technological developments make this a possibility in the near future.

We propose that the archaeologists have actually been sampling the debris carried by ancient flood channels beneath the site, including charcoal transported from bushfires that intermittently occurred within the catchment. Flood events more likely explain the accumulation of megafauna remains, and could have mixed old bones with fresh deposits. European graziers also disturbed the site in 1876 by constructing a well to provide water for their cattle. Given the expense of well-digging, we speculate that the graziers made sure it was protected from the damage caused by cattle hooves by lining the surface with small stones collected from further afield, including prehistoric quarries. This idea is consistent with the thin layer of stones spread over a large area, with cattle occasionally breaking through the gravel surface and forcing the stone and even cattle bones deeper into the waterlogged soil.

The lack of conclusive evidence that humans and megafauna coexisted for a lengthy period casts doubt on Field and Wroe's assertion that climate change was responsible for the extinction of Australia's megafauna. However, we do not suggest that newly arrived, well-armed hunters systematically slaughtered all the large beasts they encountered. Recent studies based on the biology of modern-day large mammals, combined with observations of people who still practise a traditional hunter-gatherer lifestyle, reveal an unexpected paradox and suggest a further possible explanation as to what happened. Using a mathematical model, it was found that a group of 10 people killing only one juvenile Diprotodon each year would be sufficient to bring about the extinction of that species within 1,000 years. This suggests that here, as in other parts of the world, the arrival of humans in lands previously inhabited only by animals created a volatile combination in which large animals fared badly.

## Questions 27–30

*Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?*

*In boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet write*

**YES** — if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer
**NO** — if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer
**NOT GIVEN** — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

**27** Field and Wroe argue that findings at the Cuddie Springs site show that people lived in this area at the same time as megafauna.

**28** Field and Wroe believe it is likely that smaller megafauna species survived the last Ice Age.

**29** The writers believe that the dating of earth up to 1.7 m below the present surface at Cuddie Springs is unreliable.

**30** Some artefacts found at Cuddie Springs were preserved well enough to reveal their function.

## Questions 31–35

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–I**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–I**, in boxes 31–35 on your answer sheet.*

### The writers' arguments against Field and Wroe's analysis of the scientific data from Cuddie Springs

One objection to Field and Wroe's interpretation is the large quantity of charcoal, **31** _____ and artefacts found at Cuddie Springs. Such large numbers of artefacts would be impossible if the area had been covered with **32** _____ for a period. There is also a complete lack of man-made structures, for instance those used for **33** _____.

Other evidence that casts doubt on Field and Wroe's claim is the fact that while some material in the highest levels of sediment is 36,000 years old, the **34** _____ in the same levels is much more recent. The tools used to process plants and animals may also be newer than Field and Wroe believe. Further evidence against human occupation of the area is the absence of tools and **35** _____ just a short distance away.

**A** seeds
**B** stone
**C** sand
**D** cooking
**E** deep drill core
**F** water
**G** fossil bones

**H** sediment
**I** storage

## Questions 36–40

*Choose the correct letter,* ***A, B, C or D****.*

*Write the correct letter in boxes 36–40 on your answer sheet.*

**36 What conclusions did the writers reach about the inconsistencies in the data from Cuddie Springs?**

**A** The different layers of sediment have been mixed over time.
**B** The sand evidence is unhelpful and should be disregarded.
**C** The area needs to be re-examined when technology improves.
**D** The charcoal found in the area cannot be dated.

**37 According to the writers, what impact could a natural phenomenon have had on this site?**

**A** Floods could have caused the death of the megafauna.
**B** Floods could have disturbed the archaeological evidence.
**C** Bushfires could have prevented humans from settling in the area for any length of time.
**D** Bushfires could have destroyed much of the evidence left by megafauna and humans.

**38 What did the writers speculate about the people who lived at this site in 1876?**

**A** They bred cattle whose bones could have been confused with megafauna.
**B** They found that the soil was too waterlogged for farming.
**C** They allowed cattle to move around freely at the site.
**D** They brought stones there from another area.

**39 In the final paragraph, what suggestion do the writers make about Australia's megafauna?**

**A** A rapid change in climate may have been responsible for the extinction of the megafauna.
**B** Megafauna could have died out as a result of small numbers being killed year after year.
**C** The population of humans at that time was probably insufficient to cause the extinction of the megafauna.
**D** The extinction of ancient animals should not be compared to that of modern-day species.

**40 Which of the following best represents the writers' criticism of Field and Wroe?**

**A** Their methods were not well thought out.
**B** The excavations did not go deep enough.
**C** Their technology failed to obtain precise data.
**D** Their conclusions were based on inconsistent data.

**ĐÁP ÁN:**

**27. YES:** Field và Wroe lập luận rằng những phát hiện tại Cuddie Springs cho thấy con người và động vật khổng lồ từng sống cùng thời điểm (Đoạn 2: họ khẳng định có bằng chứng về một sự chồng chéo thời gian dài).

**28. NOT GIVEN:** Field và Wroe tin rằng các loài động vật khổng lồ nhỏ hơn có khả năng sống sót sau kỷ Băng hà cuối cùng. (Bài đọc không đề cập đến việc loài nhỏ hơn có sống sót hay không).

**29. NO:** Các tác giả tin rằng việc xác định niên đại của đất ở độ sâu 1,7m tại Cuddie Springs là không đáng tin cậy. (Sai, đoạn 3 khẳng định việc xác định niên đại của các lớp này là **chính xác** - *accurate*).

**30. YES:** Một số hiện vật tại Cuddie Springs được bảo quản đủ tốt để tiết lộ chức năng của chúng (Đoạn 3: dấu vết trên công cụ đá cho thấy chúng được dùng để chế biến thực vật và giết mổ động vật).

**31. B (stone):** Một sự phản đối là lượng lớn than củi, **đá** và hiện vật được tìm thấy.

**32. F (water):** Số lượng hiện vật lớn như vậy là không thể nếu khu vực này bị **nước** bao phủ trong một thời gian (hồ không khô cạn).

**33. D (cooking):** Thiếu hoàn toàn các cấu trúc do con người tạo ra, ví dụ như hố dùng để **nấu ăn** (oven pits).

**34. C (sand):** Trong khi vật liệu ở lớp trên cùng có niên đại 36.000 năm, thì **cát** ở cùng lớp đó lại mới hơn nhiều.

**35. G (fossil bones):** Một bằng chứng khác là sự vắng mặt của công cụ và **xương hóa thạch** ở một khoảng cách ngắn gần đó.

**36. A:** Các tác giả kết luận rằng các lớp trầm tích khác nhau đã bị trộn lẫn theo thời gian (do đó dữ liệu niên đại mới mâu thuẫn).

**37. B:** Theo các tác giả, hiện tượng lũ lụt có thể đã làm xáo trộn các bằng chứng khảo cổ học.

**38. D:** Các tác giả suy đoán rằng những người sống tại đây năm 1876 đã mang đá từ khu vực khác đến (để lót bề mặt giếng nước).

**39. B:** Trong đoạn cuối, tác giả gợi ý rằng động vật khổng lồ có thể đã tuyệt chủng do một số lượng nhỏ bị giết năm này qua năm khác (mô hình toán học: chỉ cần 10 người giết 1 con non mỗi năm).

**40. D:** Sự chỉ trích của các tác giả đối với Field và Wroe là kết luận của họ dựa trên dữ liệu không nhất quán.